18 Hadad and his men set out from Midian and went to Paran. They took men from
Paran with them and went to Egypt, to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave Hadad
a house and land and provided him with food. 19 There Hadad found such great
favor in the sight of Pharaoh that he gave to him in marriage the sister of Queen
Tahpenes, his own wife. 20 And the sister of Tahpenes bore Hadad a son named
Genubath. Tahpenes herself weaned him in Pharaoh's palace, and Genubath lived
there among the sons of Pharaoh. 21 When Hadad heard in Egypt that David had
rested with his fathers and that Joab, the commander of the army, was dead, he said
to Pharaoh, "Let me go, that I may return to my own country." 22 But Pharaoh
asked him, "What have you lacked here with me that you suddenly want to go back
to your own country?" "Nothing," Hadad replied, "but please let me go." 23 And
God raised up against Solomon another adversary, Rezon the son of Eliada, who
had fled from his master, Hadadezer king of Zobah, 24 and had gathered men to
himself. When David killed the Zobaites, Rezon captained a band of raiders and
went to Damascus, where they settled and gained control. 25 Rezon was Israel's
enemy throughout the days of Solomon, adding to the trouble caused by Hadad.
So Rezon ruled over Aram with hostility toward Israel. 26 Now Jeroboam son of
Nebat was an Ephraimite from Zeredah whose mother was a widow named Zeruah.
Jeroboam was a servant of Solomon, but he rebelled against the king, 27 and this
is the account of his rebellion against the king. Solomon had built the supporting
terraces and repaired the gap in the wall of the city of his father David.

28 Now Jeroboam was a mighty man of valor. So when Solomon noticed that the
young man was industrious, he put him in charge of the whole labor force of the
house of Joseph.

29 During that time, the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite met Jeroboam on the road
as he was going out of Jerusalem. Now Ahijah had wrapped himself in a new cloak,
and the two of them were alone in the open field. 30 And Ahijah took hold of the
new cloak he was wearing, tore it into twelve pieces, 31 and said to Jeroboam, "Take
ten pieces for yourself, for this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold,
I will tear the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon, and I will give you ten tribes.'"
32 But one tribe will remain for the sake of My servant David and for the sake of
Jerusalem, the city I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel. 33 For they have
forsaken Me to worship Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh the god
of the Moabites, and Milcom the god of the Ammonites. They have not walked in
My ways, nor done what is right in My eyes, nor kept My statutes and judgments,
as Solomon's father David did. 34 Nevertheless, I will not take the whole kingdom
out of Solomon's hand, because I have made him ruler all the days of his life for
the sake of David My servant, whom I chose because he kept My commandments
and statutes. 35 But I will take ten tribes of the kingdom from the hand of his son
and give them to you. 36 I will give one tribe to his son, so that My servant David will
always have a lamp before Me in Jerusalem, the city where I chose to put My Name.
37 But as for you, I will take you, and you shall reign over all that your heart desires,
and you will be king over Israel. 38 If you listen to all that I command you, walk
in My ways, and do what is right in My sight in order to keep My statutes and
commandments as My servant David did, then I will be with you. I will build you
a lasting dynasty just as I built for David, and I will give Israel to you. 39 "Because of
this, I will humble David's descendants—but not forever.'" 40 Solomon therefore
sought to kill Jeroboam. But Jeroboam arose and fled to Egypt, to Shishak king of
Egypt, where he remained until the death of Solomon. 41 As for the rest of the acts of
Solomon—all that he did, as well as his wisdom—are they not written in the Book
of the Acts of Solomon? 42 Thus the time that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over
all Israel was forty years. 43 And Solomon rested with his fathers and was buried in
the city of his father David. And his son Rehoboam reigned in his place.

12 Then Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had gone there to make
him king. 2 When Jeroboam son of Nebat heard about this, he was still in Egypt
where he had fled from King Solomon and had been living ever since. 3 So they sent
for Jeroboam, and he and the whole assembly of Israel came to Rehoboam and said,
4 "Your father put a heavy yoke on us. But now you should lighten the burden
of your father's service and the heavy yoke he put on us, and we will serve you."
5 Rehoboam answered, "Go away for three days and then return to me." So the
people departed. 6 Then King Rehoboam consulted with the elders who had served
his father Solomon during his lifetime. "How do you advise me to respond to these
people?" he asked. 7 They replied, "If you will be a servant to these people and serve
them this day, and if you will respond by speaking kind words to them, they will be
your servants forever." 8 But Rehoboam rejected the advice of the elders; instead,
he consulted the young men who had grown up with him and served him. 9 He
asked them, "What message do you advise that we send back to these people who
have spoken to me, saying, 'Lighten the yoke your father put on us'?" 10 The young
men who had grown up with him replied, "This is how you should answer these
people who said to you, 'Your father made our yoke heavy, but you should make
it lighter.' This is what you should tell them: 'My little finger is thicker than my
father's waist!'"

11 "Whereas my father burdened you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke.
Whereas my father scourged you with whips, I will scourge you with scorpions.'"
12 After three days, Jeroboam and all the people returned to Rehoboam, since the
king had said, "Come back to me on the third day." 13 And the king answered the
people harshly. He rejected the advice of the elders 14 and spoke to them as the
young men had advised, saying, "Whereas my father made your yoke heavy, I will
add to your yoke. Whereas my father scourged you with whips, I will scourge you
with scorpions." 15 So the king did not listen to the people, and indeed this turn of
events was from the LORD, to fulfill the word He had spoken to Jeroboam son of
Nebat through Ahijah the Shilonite. 16 When all Israel saw that the king had refused
to listen to them, they answered the king: "What portion do we have in David, and
what inheritance in the son of Jesse? To your tents, O Israel! Look now to your
own house, O David!" So the Israelites went home, 17 but Rehoboam still reigned
over the Israelites living in the cities of Judah. 18 Then King Rehoboam sent out
Adoram, who was in charge of the forced labor, but all Israel stoned him to death.
And King Rehoboam mounted his chariot in haste and escaped to Jerusalem.

19 So to this day Israel has been in rebellion against the house of David. 20 When all
Israel heard that Jeroboam had returned, they summoned him to the assembly and
made him king over all Israel. Only the tribe of Judah followed the house of David.
21 And when Rehoboam arrived in Jerusalem, he mobilized the whole house of
Judah and the tribe of Benjamin—180,000 chosen warriors—to fight against the
house of Israel and restore the kingdom to Rehoboam son of Solomon.

22 But the word of God came to Shemaiah the man of God: 23 "Tell Rehoboam son
of Solomon king of Judah, all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and the rest of
the people" 24 "that this is what the LORD says: 'You are not to go up and fight
against your brothers, the Israelites. Each of you must return home, for this word is
from Me.'" So they listened to the word of the LORD and turned back according
to the word of the LORD. 25 Then Jeroboam built Shechem in the hill country of
Ephraim and lived there. And from there he went out and built Penuel. 26 Jeroboam
said in his heart, "Now the kingdom might revert to the house of David." 27 "If
these people go up to offer sacrifices in the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, their
hearts will return to their lord, Rehoboam king of Judah; then they will kill me and
return to Rehoboam king of Judah." 28 After seeking advice, the king made two
golden calves and said to the people, "Going up to Jerusalem is too much for you.
Here, O Israel, are your gods, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt." 29 One
calf he set up in Bethel, and the other in Dan. 30 And this thing became a sin; the
people walked as far as Dan to worship before one of the calves. 31 Jeroboam also
built shrines on the high places and appointed from every class of people priests
who were not Levites. 32 And Jeroboam ordained a feast on the fifteenth day of
the eighth month, like the feast that was in Judah, and he offered sacrifices on the
altar; he made this offering in Bethel to sacrifice to the calves he had set up, and he
installed priests in Bethel for the high places he had set up. 33 On the fifteenth day
of the eighth month, a month of his own choosing, Jeroboam offered sacrifices on
the altar he had set up in Bethel. So he ordained a feast for the Israelites, offered
sacrifices on the altar, and burned incense.

13 Suddenly, as Jeroboam was standing beside the altar to burn incense, there
came a man of God from Judah to Bethel by the word of the LORD. 2 And he cried
out against the altar by the word of the LORD, "O altar, O altar, this is what the
LORD says: 'A son named Josiah will be born to the house of David, and upon
you he will sacrifice the priests of the high places who burn incense upon you, and
human bones will be burned upon you.'" 3 That day the man of God gave a sign,
saying, "The LORD has spoken this sign: 'Surely the altar will be split apart, and
the ashes upon it will be poured out.'" 4 Now when King Jeroboam, who was at
the altar in Bethel, heard the word that the man of God had cried out against it, he
stretched out his hand and said, "Seize him!" But the hand he stretched out toward
him withered, so that he could not pull it back. 5 And the altar was split apart, and
the ashes poured out, according to the sign that the man of God had given by the
word of the LORD. 6 Then the king responded to the man of God, "Intercede
with the LORD your God and pray that my hand may be restored." So the man
of God interceded with the LORD, and the king's hand was restored to him as it
was before. 7 Then the king said to the man of God, "Come home with me and
refresh yourself, and I will give you a reward." 8 But the man of God replied, "If you
were to give me half your possessions, I still would not go with you, nor would I
eat bread or drink water in this place." 9 "For this is what I was commanded by the
word of the LORD: 'You must not eat bread or drink water or return by the way
you came.'" 10 So the man of God went another way and did not return by the way
he had come to Bethel.

11 Now a certain old prophet was living in Bethel, and his sons came and told him
all the deeds that the man of God had done that day in Bethel. They also told their
father the words that the man had spoken to the king. 12 "Which way did he go?"
their father asked. And his sons showed him the way taken by the man of God, who
had come from Judah. 13 So the prophet said to his sons, "Saddle the donkey for
me." Then they saddled the donkey for him, and he mounted it 14 and went after the
man of God. He found him sitting under an oak tree and asked, "Are you the man of
God who came from Judah?" "I am," he replied. 15 So the prophet said to the man of
God, "Come home with me and eat some bread." 16 But the man replied, "I cannot
return with you or eat bread or drink water with you in this place." 17 "For I have
been told by the word of the LORD: 'You must not eat bread or drink water there or

return by the way you came.'" [18] Then the prophet replied, "I too am a prophet like you, and an angel spoke to me by the word of the LORD, saying, 'Bring him back with you to your house, so that he may eat bread and drink water.'" The old prophet was lying to him, [19] but the man of God went back with him, ate bread in his house, and drank water. [20] While they were sitting at the table, the word of the LORD came to the prophet who had brought him back, [21] and the prophet cried out to the man of God who had come from Judah, "This is what the LORD says: 'Because you have defied the word of the LORD and have not kept the commandment that the LORD your God gave you,'" [22] "but you went back and ate bread and drank water in the place where He told you not to do so, your body shall never reach the tomb of your fathers.'" [23] And after the man of God had finished eating and drinking, the old prophet who had brought him back saddled the donkey for him. [24] As he went on his way, a lion met him on the road and killed him, and his body was left lying in the road, with the donkey and the lion standing beside it. [25] And there were men passing by who saw the body lying in the road with the lion standing beside it, and they went and reported this in the city where the old prophet lived. [26] When the prophet who had brought him back from his journey heard this, he said, "It is the man of God who disobeyed the command of the LORD. Therefore the LORD has delivered him to the lion, and it has mauled him and killed him, according to the word that the LORD had spoken to him." [27] Then the old prophet instructed his sons, "Saddle the donkey for me." So they saddled it, [28] and he went and found the body lying in the road, with the donkey and the lion standing beside it. The lion had not eaten the body or mauled the donkey. [29] So the old prophet lifted up the body of the man of God, laid it on the donkey, and brought it back to his own city to mourn for him and bury him. [30] Then he laid the body in his own tomb, and they lamented over him, "Oh, my brother!" [31] After he had buried him, the prophet said to his sons, "When I die, you must bury me in the tomb where the man of God is buried. Lay my bones beside his bones," [32] "for the message that he cried out by the word of the LORD against the altar in Bethel and against all the shrines on the high places in the cities of Samaria will surely come to pass." [33] Even after these events, Jeroboam did not repent of his evil ways, but again he appointed priests for the high places from every class of people. He ordained anyone who desired to be a priest of the high places. [34] And this was the sin of the house of Jeroboam that led to its extermination and destruction from the face of the earth.

14 At that time Abijah son of Jeroboam became ill, [2] and Jeroboam said to his wife, "Now get up, disguise yourself so they will not recognize you as my wife, and go to Shiloh. For Ahijah the prophet is there; it was he who spoke about my kingship over this people." [3] "Take with you ten loaves of bread, some cakes, and a jar of honey, and go to him. He will tell you what will become of the boy." [4] Jeroboam's wife did as instructed; she arose and went to Shiloh and arrived at Ahijah's house. Now Ahijah could not see, for his eyes were dim because of his age. [5] But the LORD had said to Ahijah, "Behold, the wife of Jeroboam is coming to ask you about her son, for he is ill. You are to say such and such to her, because when she arrives, she will be disguised." [6] So when Ahijah heard the sound of her feet entering the door, he said, "Come in, wife of Jeroboam! Why are you disguised? For I have been sent to you with bad news." [7] Go, tell Jeroboam that this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I raised you up from among the people and appointed you ruler over My people Israel.' [8] I tore the kingdom away from the house of David and gave it to you. But you were not like My servant David, who kept My commandments and followed Me with all his heart, doing only what was right in My eyes. [9] You have done more evil than all who came before you. You have proceeded to make for yourself other gods and molten images to provoke Me, and you have flung Me behind your back.

[10] Because of all this, behold, I am bringing disaster on the house of Jeroboam: I will cut off from Jeroboam every male, both slave and free, in Israel; I will burn up the house of Jeroboam as one burns up dung until it is gone! [11] Anyone belonging to Jeroboam who dies in the city will be eaten by dogs, and anyone who dies in the field will be eaten by the birds of the air.' For the LORD has spoken. [12] As for you, get up and go home. When your feet enter the city, the child will die. [13] All Israel will mourn for him and bury him. For this is the only one belonging to Jeroboam who will receive a proper burial, because only in him has the LORD, the God of Israel, found any good in the house of Jeroboam. [14] Moreover, the LORD will raise up for Himself a king over Israel who will cut off the house of Jeroboam. This is the day—yes, even today! [15] For the LORD will strike Israel as a reed is shaken in the water. He will uproot Israel from this good land that He gave their fathers, and He will scatter them beyond the Euphrates, because they have made their Asherah poles, provoking the LORD to anger. [16] "So He will give Israel over on account of the sins Jeroboam has committed and has caused Israel to commit."

[17] Then Jeroboam's wife got up and departed for Tirzah, and as soon as she stepped over the threshold of the house, the boy died. [18] And they buried him, and all Israel mourned for him, according to the word that the LORD had spoken through His servant Ahijah the prophet. [19] As for the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he waged war and how he reigned, they are indeed written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

[20] And the length of Jeroboam's reign was twenty-two years, and he rested with his fathers, and his son Nadab reigned in his place. [21] Meanwhile, Rehoboam son of Solomon reigned in Judah. He was forty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city the LORD had chosen from all the tribes of Israel in which to put His Name. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. [22] And Judah did evil in the sight of the LORD, and by the sins they committed they provoked Him to jealous anger more than all their fathers had done. [23] They also built for themselves high places, sacred pillars, and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every green tree. [24] There were even male shrine prostitutes in the land. They imitated all the abominations of the nations the LORD had driven out before the Israelites. [25] In the fifth year of Rehoboam's reign, Shishak king of Egypt came up and attacked Jerusalem. [26] He seized the treasures of the house of the LORD and of the royal palace. He took everything, including all the gold shields that Solomon had made. [27] Then King Rehoboam made bronze shields in their place and committed them to the care of the captains of the guard on duty at the entrance to the royal palace. [28] And whenever the king entered the house of the LORD, the guards would bear the shields, and later they would return them to the guardroom. [29] As for the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, along with all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [30] There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam throughout their days. [31] And Rehoboam rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the City of David; his mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. And his son Abijam reigned in his place.

15 In the eighteenth year of the reign of Jeroboam son of Nebat, Abijam became king of Judah, [2] and he reigned in Jerusalem three years. His mother's name was Maacah daughter of Abishalom. [3] And Abijam walked in all the sins that his father before him had committed, and his heart was not as fully devoted to the LORD his God as the heart of David his forefather had been. [4] Nevertheless, for the sake of David, the LORD his God gave him a lamp in Jerusalem by raising up a son to succeed him and to make Jerusalem strong. [5] For David had done what was right in the eyes of the LORD and had not turned aside from anything the LORD commanded all the days of his life, except in the matter of Uriah the Hittite. [6] And there was war between the houses of Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of Abijam's life. [7] As for the rest of the acts of Abijam, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? And there was war between Abijam and Jeroboam. [8] And Abijam rested with his fathers and was buried in the City of David, and his son Asa reigned in his place. [9] In the twentieth year of Jeroboam's reign over Israel, Asa became king of Judah, [10] and he reigned in Jerusalem forty-one years. His grandmother's name was Maacah daughter of Abishalom.

[11] And Asa did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, as his father David had done. [12] He banished the male shrine prostitutes from the land and removed all the idols that his fathers had made. [13] He also removed his grandmother Maacah from her position as queen mother because she had made a detestable Asherah pole. Asa chopped down the pole and burned it in the Kidron Valley. [14] The high places were not removed, but Asa's heart was fully devoted to the LORD all his days. [15] And he brought into the house of the LORD the silver and gold and other articles that he and his father had dedicated. [16] Now there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel throughout their days. [17] Baasha king of Israel went to war against Judah and fortified Ramah to prevent anyone from leaving or entering the territory of Asa king of Judah.

[18] So Asa withdrew all the silver and gold that remained in the treasuries of the house of the LORD and the royal palace. He entrusted it to his servants and sent them with this message to Ben-hadad son of Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion king of Aram, who was ruling in Damascus: [19] "Let there be a treaty between me and you, between my father and your father. See, I have sent you a gift of silver and gold. Now go and break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel, so that he will withdraw from me." [20] And Ben-hadad listened to King Asa and sent the commanders of his armies against the cities of Israel, conquering Ijon, Dan, Abel-beth-maacah, and the whole land of Naphtali, including the region of Chinnereth. [21] When Baasha learned of this, he stopped fortifying Ramah and withdrew to Tirzah.

[22] Then King Asa summoned all the men of Judah, with no exceptions, and they carried away the stones of Ramah and the timbers Baasha had used for building. And with these materials King Asa built up Geba of Benjamin, as well as Mizpah. [23] Now the rest of the acts of Asa, along with all his might, all his accomplishments, and the cities he built, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? In his old age, however, he became diseased in his feet. [24] And Asa rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the city of his father David, and his son Jehoshaphat reigned in his place. [25] In the second year of Asa's reign over Judah, Nadab son of Jeroboam became king of Israel, and he reigned two years. [26] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the way of his father and in his sin, which he had caused Israel to commit. [27] Then Baasha son of Ahijah of the house of Issachar conspired against Nadab, and Baasha struck him down at Gibbethon of the Philistines while Nadab and all Israel were besieging the city. [28] In the third year of Asa's reign over Judah, Baasha killed Nadab and reigned in

his place. [29] As soon as Baasha became king, he struck down the entire household of Jeroboam. He did not leave to Jeroboam anyone that breathed, but destroyed them all according to the word that the LORD had spoken through His servant Ahijah the Shilonite, [30] because of the sins Jeroboam had committed and had caused Israel to commit, and because he had provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger. [31] As for the rest of the acts of Nadab, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [32] And there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel throughout their days. [33] In the third year of Asa's reign over Judah, Baasha son of Ahijah became king of all Israel, and he reigned in Tirzah twenty-four years. [34] And Baasha did evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the way of Jeroboam and in his sin, which he had caused Israel to commit.

16 Then the word of the LORD came to Jehu son of Hanani against Baasha, saying: [2] "Even though I lifted you out of the dust and made you ruler over My people Israel, you have walked in the way of Jeroboam and have caused My people Israel to sin and to provoke Me to anger by their sins." [3] So now I will consume Baasha and his house, and I will make your house like that of Jeroboam son of Nebat: [4] "Anyone belonging to Baasha who dies in the city will be eaten by dogs, and anyone who dies in the field will be eaten by the birds of the air." [5] As for the rest of the acts of Baasha, along with his accomplishments and might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [6] And Baasha rested with his fathers and was buried in Tirzah, and his son Elah reigned in his place. [7] Moreover, the word of the LORD came through the prophet Jehu son of Hanani against Baasha and his house, because of all the evil he had done in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger with the work of his hands and becoming like the house of Jeroboam, and also because Baasha had struck down the house of Jeroboam.

[8] In the twenty-sixth year of Asa's reign over Judah, Elah son of Baasha became king of Israel, and he reigned in Tirzah two years. [9] However, while Elah was in Tirzah getting drunk in the house of Arza the steward of his household there, Elah's servant Zimri, the commander of half his chariots, conspired against him. [10] So in the twenty-seventh year of Asa's reign over Judah, Zimri went in, struck Elah down, and killed him. And Zimri reigned in his place.

[11] As soon as Zimri began to reign and was seated on the throne, he struck down the entire household of Baasha. He did not leave a single male, whether a kinsman or friend. [12] So Zimri destroyed the entire household of Baasha, according to the word that the LORD had spoken against Baasha through Jehu the prophet. [13] This happened because of all the sins Baasha and his son Elah had committed and had caused Israel to commit, provoking the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger with their worthless idols. [14] As for the rest of the acts of Elah, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?

[15] In the twenty-seventh year of Asa's reign over Judah, Zimri reigned in Tirzah for seven days. Now the troops were encamped against Gibbethon of the Philistines, [16] and the people in the camp heard that Zimri had not only conspired but had also struck down the king. So there in the camp that very day, all Israel proclaimed Omri, the commander of the army, king over Israel. [17] Then Omri and all the Israelites marched up from Gibbethon and besieged Tirzah. [18] When Zimri saw that the city was captured, he entered the citadel of the royal palace and burned it down upon himself. So he died [19] because of the sins he had committed, doing evil in the sight of the LORD and following the example of Jeroboam and the sin he had committed and had caused Israel to commit. [20] As for the rest of the acts of Zimri and the treason he committed, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?

[21] At that time the people of Israel were divided: Half of the people supported Tibni son of Ginath as king, and half supported Omri.

[22] But the followers of Omri proved stronger than those of Tibni son of Ginath. So Tibni died and Omri became king.

[23] In the thirty-first year of Asa's reign over Judah, Omri became king of Israel, and he reigned twelve years, six of them in Tirzah. [24] He bought the hill of Samaria from Shemer for two talents of silver and built a city there, calling it Samaria after the name of Shemer, who had owned the hill. [25] But Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD and acted more wickedly than all who were before him. [26] For he walked in all the ways of Jeroboam son of Nebat and in his sins, which he caused Israel to commit, provoking the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger with their worthless idols. [27] As for the rest of the acts of Omri, along with his accomplishments and the might he exercised, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [28] And Omri rested with his fathers and was buried in Samaria, and his son Ahab reigned in his place.

[29] In the thirty-eighth year of Asa's reign over Judah, Ahab son of Omri became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria twenty-two years. [30] However, Ahab son of Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD, more than all who were before him. [31] And as if it were not enough for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam son of Nebat, he even married Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and he then proceeded to serve and worship Baal. [32] First, Ahab set up an altar for Baal in the temple of Baal that he had built in Samaria. [33] Then he set up an Asherah pole. Thus Ahab did more to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger than all the kings of Israel before him. [34] In Ahab's days, Hiel the Bethelite rebuilt Jericho. At the cost of Abiram his firstborn he laid its foundation, and at the cost of Segub his youngest he set up its gates, according to the word that the LORD had spoken through Joshua son of Nun.

17 Now Elijah the Tishbite, who was among the settlers of Gilead, said to Ahab, "As surely as the LORD lives—the God of Israel before whom I stand—there will be neither dew nor rain in these years except at my word!" [2] Then a revelation from the LORD came to Elijah: [3] "Leave here, turn eastward, and hide yourself by the Brook of Cherith, east of the Jordan." [4] "And you are to drink from the brook, and I have commanded the ravens to feed you there." [5] So Elijah did what the LORD had told him, and he went and lived by the Brook of Cherith, east of the Jordan. [6] The ravens would bring him bread and meat in the morning and evening, and he would drink from the brook. [7] Some time later, however, the brook dried up because there had been no rain in the land.

[8] Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah: [9] "Get up and go to Zarephath of Sidon, and stay there. Behold, I have commanded a widow there to provide for you."

[10] So Elijah got up and went to Zarephath. When he arrived at the city gate, there was a widow gathering sticks. Elijah called to her and said, "Please bring me a little water in a cup, so that I may drink." [11] And as she was going to get it, he called to her and said, "Please bring me a piece of bread." [12] But she replied, "As surely as the LORD your God lives, I have no bread—only a handful of flour in a jar and a little oil in a jug. Look, I am gathering a couple of sticks to take home and prepare a meal for myself and my son, so that we may eat it and die." [13] "Do not be afraid," Elijah said to her. "Go and do as you have said. But first make me a small cake of bread from what you have, and bring it out to me. Afterward, make some for yourself and your son," [14] "for this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'The jar of flour will not be exhausted and the jug of oil will not run dry until the day the LORD sends rain upon the face of the earth.'" [15] So she went and did according to the word of Elijah, and there was food every day for Elijah and the woman and her household.

[16] The jar of flour was not exhausted and the jug of oil did not run dry, according to the word that the LORD had spoken through Elijah. [17] Later, the son of the woman who owned the house became ill, and his sickness grew worse and worse, until no breath remained in him. [18] "O man of God," said the woman to Elijah, "what have you done to me? Have you come to remind me of my iniquity and cause the death of my son?" [19] But Elijah said to her, "Give me your son." So he took him from her arms, carried him to the upper room where he was staying, and laid him on his own bed. [20] Then he cried out to the LORD, "O LORD my God, have You also brought tragedy on this widow who has opened her home to me, by causing her son to die?" [21] Then he stretched himself out over the child three times and cried out to the LORD, "O LORD my God, please let this boy's life return to him!" [22] And the LORD listened to the voice of Elijah, and the child's life returned to him, and he lived. [23] Then Elijah took the child, brought him down from the upper room into the house, and gave him to his mother. "Look, your son is alive," Elijah declared. [24] Then the woman said to Elijah, "Now I know that you are a man of God and that the word of the LORD from your mouth is truth."

18 After a long time, in the third year of the drought, the word of the LORD came to Elijah: "Go and present yourself to Ahab, and I will send rain upon the face of the earth." [2] So Elijah went to present himself to Ahab. The famine was severe in Samaria, [3] and Ahab summoned Obadiah, who was in charge of the palace. (Now Obadiah greatly feared the LORD, [4] for when Jezebel had slaughtered the prophets of the LORD, Obadiah had taken a hundred prophets and hidden them, fifty men per cave, providing them with food and water.) [5] Then Ahab said to Obadiah, "Go throughout the land to every spring and every valley. Perhaps we will find grass to keep the horses and mules alive so that we will not have to destroy any livestock." [6] So they divided the land to explore. Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went the other way by himself. [7] Now as Obadiah went on his way, Elijah suddenly met him. When Obadiah recognized him, he fell facedown and said, "Is it you, my lord Elijah?" [8] "It is I," he answered. "Go tell your master, 'Elijah is here!'" [9] But Obadiah replied, "How have I sinned, that you are handing your servant over to Ahab to put me to death?" [10] As surely as the LORD your God lives, there is no nation or kingdom where my lord has not sent someone to search for you. When they said, 'He is not here,' he made that kingdom or nation swear that they had not found you. [11] And now you say, 'Go tell your master that Elijah is here!' [12] I do not know where the Spirit of the LORD may carry you off when I leave you. Then when I go and tell Ahab and he does not find you, he will kill me. But I, your servant, have feared the LORD from my youth. [13] Was it not reported to my lord what I did when Jezebel slaughtered the prophets of the LORD? I hid a hundred prophets of the LORD, fifty men per cave, and I provided them with food and water. [14] "And now you say, 'Go tell your lord that Elijah is here!' He will kill me!"

15 Then Elijah said, "As surely as the LORD of Hosts lives, before whom I stand,
I will present myself to Ahab today." 16 So Obadiah went to inform Ahab, who
went to meet Elijah. 17 When Ahab saw Elijah, he said to him, "Is that you, O
troubler of Israel?" 18 "I have not troubled Israel," Elijah replied, "but you and your
father's house have, for you have forsaken the commandments of the LORD and
have followed the Baals." 19 "Now summon all Israel to meet me on Mount Carmel,
along with the four hundred and fifty prophets of Baal and the four hundred
prophets of Asherah who eat at Jezebel's table."

20 So Ahab summoned all the Israelites and assembled the prophets on
Mount Carmel. 21 Then Elijah approached all the people and said, "How long
will you waver between two opinions? If the LORD is God, follow Him. But if
Baal is God, follow him." But the people did not answer a word. 22 Then Elijah
said to the people, "I am the only remaining prophet of the LORD, but Baal has
four hundred and fifty prophets." 23 Get two bulls for us. Let the prophets of Baal
choose one bull for themselves, cut it into pieces, and place it on the wood but not
light the fire. And I will prepare the other bull and place it on the wood but not
light the fire. 24 "Then you may call on the name of your god, and I will call on
the name of the LORD. The God who answers by fire, He is God." And all the
people answered, "What you say is good." 25 Then Elijah said to the prophets of
Baal, "Since you are so numerous, choose for yourselves one bull and prepare it first.
Then call on the name of your god, but do not light the fire." 26 And they took the
bull that was given them, prepared it, and called on the name of Baal from morning
until noon, shouting, "O Baal, answer us!" But there was no sound, and no one
answered as they leaped around the altar they had made. 27 At noon Elijah began to
taunt them, saying, "Shout louder, for he is a god! Perhaps he is deep in thought,
or occupied, or on a journey. Perhaps he is sleeping and must be awakened!" 28 So
they shouted louder and cut themselves with knives and lances, as was their custom,
until the blood gushed over them. 29 Midday passed, and they kept on raving until
the time of the evening sacrifice. But there was no response; no one answered, no
one paid attention.

30 Then Elijah said to all the people, "Come near to me." So all the people
approached him, and he repaired the altar of the LORD that had been torn down.
31 And Elijah took twelve stones, one for each tribe of the sons of Jacob, to whom
the word of the LORD had come and said, "Israel shall be your name." 32 And with
the stones, Elijah built an altar in the name of the LORD. Then he dug a trench
around the altar large enough to hold two seahs of seed. 33 Next, he arranged the
wood, cut up the bull, placed it on the wood, 34 and said, "Fill four waterpots and
pour the water on the offering and on the wood." "Do it a second time," he said, and
they did it a second time. "Do it a third time," he said, and they did it a third time.
35 So the water ran down around the altar and even filled the trench. 36 At the time of
the evening sacrifice, Elijah the prophet approached the altar and said, "O LORD,
God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, let it be known this day that You are God in
Israel and that I am Your servant and have done all these things at Your command."
37 "Answer me, O LORD! Answer me, so that this people will know that You,
the LORD, are God, and that You have turned their hearts back again." 38 Then
the fire of the LORD fell and consumed the sacrifice, the wood, the stones, and
the dust, and it licked up the water in the trench. 39 When all the people saw this,
they fell facedown and said, "The LORD, He is God! The LORD, He is God!"
40 Then Elijah ordered them, "Seize the prophets of Baal! Do not let a single one
escape." So they seized them, and Elijah brought them down to the Kishon Valley
and slaughtered them there. 41 And Elijah said to Ahab, "Go up, eat and drink,
for there is the sound of a heavy rain." 42 So Ahab went up to eat and drink. But
Elijah climbed to the summit of Carmel, bent down on the ground, and put his face
between his knees. 43 "Go and look toward the sea," he said to his servant. So the
servant went and looked, and he said, "There is nothing there." Seven times Elijah
said, "Go back." 44 On the seventh time the servant reported, "There is a cloud as
small as a man's hand rising from the sea." And Elijah replied, "Go and tell Ahab,
'Prepare your chariot and go down before the rain stops you.'" 45 Meanwhile, the
sky grew dark with clouds and wind, and a heavy rain began to fall. So Ahab rode
away and went to Jezreel. 46 And the hand of the LORD came upon Elijah, and he
tucked his cloak into his belt and ran ahead of Ahab all the way to Jezreel.

19 Now Ahab told Jezebel everything that Elijah had done and how he had
killed all the prophets with the sword. 2 So Jezebel sent a messenger to Elijah, saying,
"May the gods deal with me, and ever so severely, if by this time tomorrow I do not
make your life like the lives of those you killed!" 3 And Elijah was afraid and ran for
his life. When he came to Beersheba in Judah, he left his servant there, 4 while he
himself traveled on a day's journey into the wilderness. He sat down under a broom
tree and prayed that he might die. "I have had enough, LORD," he said. "Take my
life, for I am no better than my fathers." 5 Then he lay down under the broom tree
and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, "Get up and eat." 6 And
he looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals,
and a jar of water. So he ate and drank and lay down again.

7 A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, "Get
up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you." 8 So he got up and ate and
drank. And strengthened by that food, he walked forty days and forty nights until
he reached Horeb, the mountain of God.

9 There Elijah entered a cave and spent the night. And the word of the LORD
came to him, saying, "What are you doing here, Elijah?" 10 "I have been very zealous
for the LORD, the God of Hosts," he replied, "but the Israelites have forsaken Your
covenant, torn down Your altars, and killed Your prophets with the sword. I am the
only one left, and they are seeking my life as well." 11 Then the LORD said, "Go out
and stand on the mountain before the LORD. Behold, the LORD is about to pass
by." And a great and mighty wind tore into the mountains and shattered the rocks
before the LORD, but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was
an earthquake, but the LORD was not in the earthquake. 12 After the earthquake
there was a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a still,
small voice. 13 When Elijah heard it, he wrapped his face in his cloak and went out
and stood at the mouth of the cave. Suddenly a voice came to him and said, "What
are you doing here, Elijah?"

14 "I have been very zealous for the LORD, the God of Hosts," he replied, "but
the Israelites have forsaken Your covenant, torn down Your altars, and killed Your
prophets with the sword. I am the only one left, and they are seeking my life as well."
15 Then the LORD said to him, "Go back by the way you came, and go to the
Desert of Damascus. When you arrive, you are to anoint Hazael as king over Aram."
16 You are also to anoint Jehu son of Nimshi as king over Israel and Elisha son of
Shaphat from Abel-meholah to succeed you as prophet. 17 Then Jehu will put to
death whoever escapes the sword of Hazael, and Elisha will put to death whoever
escapes the sword of Jehu. 18 "Nevertheless, I have reserved seven thousand in Israel
—all whose knees have not bowed to Baal and whose mouths have not kissed him."

19 So Elijah departed and found Elisha son of Shaphat. He was plowing with
twelve teams of oxen, and he was with the twelfth team. Elijah passed by him and
threw his cloak around him. 20 So Elisha left the oxen, ran after Elijah, and said,
"Please let me kiss my father and mother goodbye, and then I will follow you." "Go
on back," Elijah replied, "for what have I done to you?" 21 So Elisha turned back
from him, took his pair of oxen, and slaughtered them. With the oxen's equipment,
he cooked the meat and gave it to the people, and they ate. Then he set out to follow
and serve Elijah.

20 Now Ben-hadad king of Aram assembled his entire army. Accompanied by
thirty-two kings with their horses and chariots, he marched up, besieged Samaria,
and waged war against it. 2 Then he sent messengers into the city to Ahab king
of Israel, 3 saying, "This is what Ben-hadad says: 'Your silver and gold are mine, and
your best wives and children are mine!'" 4 And the king of Israel replied, "Just as you
say, my lord the king: I am yours, along with all that I have." 5 The messengers came
back and said, "This is what Ben-hadad says: 'I have sent to you to demand your
silver, your gold, your wives, and your children.'" 6 "But about this time tomorrow
I will send my servants to search your palace and the houses of your servants. They
will seize and carry away all that is precious to you.'" 7 Then the king of Israel
summoned all the elders of the land and said, "Please take note and see that this
man is looking for trouble, for when he demanded my wives, my children, my silver,
and my gold, I did not deny him." 8 And the elders and the people all said, "Do not
listen to him or consent to his terms." 9 So Ahab answered the messengers of Ben-
hadad, "Tell my lord the king, 'All that you demanded of your servant the first time
I will do, but this thing I cannot do.'" So the messengers departed and relayed the
message to Ben-hadad. 10 Then Ben-hadad sent another message to Ahab: "May the
gods deal with me, and ever so severely, if enough dust remains of Samaria for each
of my men to have a handful." 11 And the king of Israel replied, "Tell him: 'The
one putting on his armor should not boast like one taking it off.'" 12 Ben-hadad
received this message while he and the kings were drinking in their tents, and he said
to his servants, "Take your positions." So they stationed themselves against the city.
13 Meanwhile a prophet approached Ahab king of Israel and declared, "This is what
the LORD says: 'Do you see this entire great army? Behold, I will deliver it into
your hand this very day, and you will know that I am the LORD.'"

14 "By whom?" Ahab asked. And the prophet replied, "This is what the LORD
says: 'By the young officers of the district governors.'" "Who will start the battle?"
asked Ahab. "You will," answered the prophet. 15 So Ahab assembled the young
officers of the district governors, and there were 232 men. And after them, he
assembled the rest of the Israelite troops, 7,000 in all. 16 They marched out
at noon while Ben-hadad and the 32 kings allied with him were in their tents
getting drunk. 17 And the young officers of the district governors marched out first.
Now Ben-hadad had sent out scouts, who reported to him, "Men are marching out
of Samaria." 18 "If they have marched out in peace," he said, "take them alive. Even if
they have marched out for war, take them alive." 19 Meanwhile, these young officers
of the district governors marched out of the city, with the army behind them,
20 and each one struck down his opponent. So the Arameans fled, with the Israelites
in pursuit. But Ben-hadad king of Aram escaped on horseback with the cavalry.
21 Then the king of Israel marched out and attacked the horses and chariots,
inflicting a great slaughter on the Arameans. 22 Afterward, the prophet approached
the king of Israel and said, "Go and strengthen your position, and take note what
you must do, for in the spring the king of Aram will come up against you."

[23] Meanwhile, the servants of the king of Aram said to him, "Their gods are gods of the hills. That is why they prevailed over us. Instead, we should fight them on the plains; surely then we will prevail." [24] So do this: Dismiss all the kings from their positions and replace them with other officers. [25] "And you must raise an army like the one you have lost—horse for horse and chariot for chariot—so we can fight the Israelites on the plain, where we will surely prevail." And the king approved their plan and acted accordingly. [26] In the spring, Ben-hadad mobilized the Arameans and went up to Aphek to fight against Israel. [27] The Israelites also mobilized, gathered supplies, and marched out to meet them. The Israelites camped before them like two small flocks of goats, while the Arameans covered the countryside.

[28] Then the man of God approached the king of Israel and said, "This is what the LORD says: 'Because the Arameans think the LORD is a god of the hills and not of the valleys, I will deliver all this great army into your hand. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'" [29] For seven days the armies camped opposite each other, and on the seventh day the battle ensued, and the Israelites struck down the Arameans—a hundred thousand foot soldiers in one day. [30] The rest of them fled into the city of Aphek, where the wall fell on twenty-seven thousand of the remaining men. Ben-hadad also fled to the city and hid in an inner room.

[31] Then the servants of Ben-hadad said to him, "Look now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful. Let us go out to the king of Israel with sackcloth around our waists and ropes around our heads. Perhaps he will spare your life." [32] So with sackcloth around their waists and ropes around their heads, they went to the king of Israel and said, "Your servant Ben-hadad says, 'Please spare my life.'" And the king answered, "Is he still alive? He is my brother." [33] Now the men were looking for a sign of hope, and they quickly grasped at this word and replied, "Yes, your brother Ben-hadad." "Go and get him!" said the king. Then Ben-hadad came out, and Ahab had him come up into his chariot. [34] Ben-hadad said to him, "I will restore the cities my father took from your father; you may set up your own marketplaces in Damascus, as my father did in Samaria." "By this treaty I release you," Ahab replied. So he made a treaty with him and sent him away. [35] Meanwhile, by the word of the LORD, one of the sons of the prophets said to his companion, "Strike me, please!" But the man refused to strike him. [36] Then the prophet said to him, "Because you have not obeyed the voice of the LORD, as soon as you depart from me a lion will kill you." And when he left, a lion found him and killed him. [37] Then the prophet found another man and said, "Strike me, please!" So the man struck him and wounded him, [38] and the prophet went and waited on the road for the king, disguising himself with a bandage over his eyes. [39] As the king passed by, he cried out to the king: "Your servant had marched out into the middle of the battle, when suddenly a man came over with a captive and told me, 'Guard this man! If he goes missing for any reason, your life will be exchanged for his life, or you will weigh out a talent of silver.'" [40] "But while your servant was busy here and there, the man disappeared." And the king of Israel said to him, "So shall your judgment be; you have pronounced it on yourself." [41] Then the prophet quickly removed the bandage from his eyes, and the king of Israel recognized him as one of the prophets. [42] And the prophet said to the king, "This is what the LORD says: 'Because you have let slip from your hand the man I had devoted to destruction, your life will be exchanged for his life, and your people for his people.'" [43] Sullen and angry, the king of Israel went home to Samaria.

21 Some time later, Naboth the Jezreelite happened to own a vineyard in Jezreel next to the palace of Ahab king of Samaria. [2] So Ahab said to Naboth, "Give me your vineyard to use as a vegetable garden, since it is next to my palace. I will give you a better vineyard in its place—or if you prefer, I will give you its value in silver." [3] But Naboth replied, "The LORD forbid that I should give you the inheritance of my fathers." [4] So Ahab went to his palace, sullen and angry because Naboth the Jezreelite had told him, "I will not give you the inheritance of my fathers." He lay down on his bed, turned his face away, and refused to eat. [5] Soon his wife Jezebel came in and asked, "Why are you so sullen that you refuse to eat?" [6] Ahab answered, "Because I spoke to Naboth the Jezreelite and told him, 'Give me your vineyard for silver, or if you wish, I will give you another vineyard in its place.' And he replied, 'I will not give you my vineyard!'" [7] But his wife Jezebel said to him, "Do you not reign over Israel? Get up, eat some food, and be cheerful, for I will get you the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite." [8] Then Jezebel wrote letters in Ahab's name, sealed them with his seal, and sent them to the elders and nobles who lived with Naboth in his city.

[9] In the letters she wrote: "Proclaim a fast and give Naboth a seat of honor among the people." [10] "But seat two scoundrels opposite him and have them testify, 'You have cursed both God and the king!' Then take him out and stone him to death." [11] So the elders and nobles who lived in Naboth's city did as Jezebel had instructed in the letters she had written to them. [12] They proclaimed a fast and gave Naboth a seat of honor among the people. [13] And the two scoundrels came in and sat opposite Naboth, and these men testified against him before the people, saying, "Naboth has cursed both God and the king!" So they took him outside the city and stoned him to death.

[14] Then they sent word to Jezebel: "Naboth has been stoned to death." [15] When Jezebel heard that Naboth had been stoned to death, she said to Ahab, "Get up and take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, who refused to give it to you for silver. For Naboth is no longer alive, but dead." [16] And when Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, he got up and went down to take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite. [17] Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying, [18] "Get up and go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, who is in Samaria. See, he is in the vineyard of Naboth, of which he has gone to take possession."

[19] "Tell him that this is what the LORD says: 'Have you not murdered a man and seized his land?' Then tell him that this is also what the LORD says: 'In the place where the dogs licked up the blood of Naboth, there also the dogs will lick up your blood—yes, yours!'" [20] When Elijah arrived, Ahab said to him, "So you have found me out, my enemy." He replied, "I have found you out because you have sold yourself to do evil in the sight of the LORD." [21] This is what the LORD says: 'I will bring calamity on you and consume your descendants; I will cut off from Ahab every male in Israel, both slave and free.' [22] I will make your house like that of Jeroboam son of Nebat and like that of Baasha son of Ahijah, because you have provoked My anger and caused Israel to sin.' [23] And the LORD also speaks concerning Jezebel: 'The dogs will devour Jezebel by the wall of Jezreel.' [24] "Anyone belonging to Ahab who dies in the city will be eaten by dogs, and anyone who dies in the field will be eaten by the birds of the air." [25] (Surely there was never one like Ahab, who sold himself to do evil in the sight of the LORD, incited by his wife Jezebel. [26] He committed the most detestable acts by going after idols, just like the Amorites whom the LORD had driven out before the Israelites.) [27] When Ahab heard these words, he tore his clothes, put on sackcloth, and fasted. He lay down in sackcloth and walked around meekly. [28] Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying: [29] "Have you seen how Ahab has humbled himself before Me? Because he has humbled himself before Me, I will not bring the calamity during his days, but I will bring it upon his house in the days of his son."

22 Then three years passed without war between Aram and Israel. [2] However, in the third year, Jehoshaphat king of Judah went down to visit the king of Israel, [3] who said to his servants, "Do you not know that Ramoth-gilead is ours, but we have failed to take it from the hand of the king of Aram?" [4] So he asked Jehoshaphat, "Will you go with me to fight against Ramoth-gilead?" Jehoshaphat answered the king of Israel, "I am like you, my people are your people, and my horses are your horses." [5] But Jehoshaphat also said to the king of Israel, "Please inquire first for the word of the LORD." [6] So the king of Israel assembled the prophets, about four hundred men, and asked them, "Should I go to war against Ramoth-gilead, or should I refrain?" "Go up," they replied, "and the Lord will deliver it into the hand of the king." [7] But Jehoshaphat asked, "Is there not still a prophet of the LORD here of whom we can inquire?" [8] The king of Israel answered, "There is still one man who can ask the LORD, but I hate him because he never prophesies anything good for me, but only bad. He is Micaiah son of Imlah." "The king should not say that!" Jehoshaphat replied. [9] So the king of Israel called one of his officials and said, "Bring Micaiah son of Imlah at once." [10] Dressed in royal attire, the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah were sitting on their thrones at the threshing floor by the entrance of the gate of Samaria, with all the prophets prophesying before them. [11] Now Zedekiah son of Chenaanah had made for himself iron horns and declared, "This is what the LORD says: 'With these you shall gore the Arameans until they are finished off.'" [12] And all the prophets were prophesying the same, saying, "Go up to Ramoth-gilead and prosper, for the LORD will deliver it into the hand of the king." [13] Then the messenger who had gone to call Micaiah instructed him, "Behold now, with one accord the words of the prophets are favorable to the king. So please let your words be like theirs, and speak favorably." [14] But Micaiah said, "As surely as the LORD lives, I will speak whatever the LORD tells me." [15] When Micaiah arrived, the king asked him, "Micaiah, should we go to war against Ramoth-gilead, or should we refrain?" "Go up and triumph," Micaiah replied, "for the LORD will give it into the hand of the king." [16] But the king said to him, "How many times must I make you swear not to tell me anything but the truth in the name of the LORD?"

[17] So Micaiah declared: "I saw all Israel scattered on the hills like sheep without a shepherd. And the LORD said, 'These people have no master; let each one return home in peace.'" [18] Then the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Did I not tell you that he never prophesies good for me, but only bad?" [19] Micaiah continued, "Therefore hear the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on His throne, and all the host of heaven standing by Him on His right and on His left." [20] And the LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab to march up and fall at Ramoth-gilead?' And one suggested this, and another that. [21] Then a spirit came forward, stood before the LORD, and said, 'I will entice him.' 'By what means?' asked the LORD. [22] And he replied, 'I will go out and be a lying spirit in the mouths of all his prophets.' 'You will surely entice him and prevail,' said the LORD. 'Go and do it.' [23] "So you see, the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouths of all these prophets of yours, and the LORD has pronounced disaster against you." [24] Then Zedekiah son of Chenaanah went up, struck Micaiah in the face, and demanded, "Which way did the Spirit of the LORD go when He departed from me to speak with you?" [25] Micaiah replied, "You will soon see, on that day when you go and hide in an inner room."

[26] And the king of Israel declared, “Take Micaiah and return him to Amon the
governor of the city and to Joash the king’s son,” [27] “and tell them that this is
what the king says: ‘Put this man in prison and feed him only bread and water
until I return safely.’” [28] But Micaiah replied, “If you ever return safely, the LORD
has not spoken through me.” Then he added, “Take heed, all you people!” [29] So
the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead.
[30] And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, “I will disguise myself and go into
battle, but you wear your royal robes.” So the king of Israel disguised himself and
went into battle. [31] Now the king of Aram had ordered his thirty-two chariot
commanders, “Do not fight with anyone, small or great, except the king of Israel.”
[32] When the chariot commanders saw Jehoshaphat, they said, “Surely this is the king
of Israel!” So they turned to fight against him, but Jehoshaphat cried out. [33] And
when the chariot commanders saw that he was not the king of Israel, they turned
back from pursuing him. [34] However, a certain man drew his bow without taking
special aim, and he struck the king of Israel between the joints of his armor. So
the king said to his charioteer, “Turn around and take me out of the battle, for I
am badly wounded!”

[35] The battle raged throughout that day, and the king was propped up in his chariot
facing the Arameans. And the blood from his wound ran out onto the floor of the
chariot, and that evening he died. [36] As the sun was setting, the cry rang out in the
army: “Every man to his own city, and every man to his own land!” [37] So the king
died and was brought to Samaria, where they buried him. [38] And the chariot was
washed at the pool of Samaria where the prostitutes bathed, and the dogs licked
up Ahab’s blood, according to the word that the LORD had spoken. [39] As for the
rest of the acts of Ahab, along with all his accomplishments and the ivory palace
and all the cities he built, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles
of the Kings of Israel? [40] And Ahab rested with his fathers, and his son Ahaziah
reigned in his place. [41] In the fourth year of Ahab’s reign over Israel, Jehoshaphat
son of Asa became king of Judah. [42] Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when
he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem twenty-five years. His mother’s name
was Azubah daughter of Shilhi. [43] And Jehoshaphat walked in all the ways of his
father Asa; he did not turn away from them, but did what was right in the eyes of
the LORD. The high places, however, were not removed; the people still sacrificed
and burned incense on the high places. [44] Jehoshaphat also made peace with the
king of Israel. [45] As for the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, along with the might he
exercised and how he waged war, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles
of the Kings of Judah? [46] He banished from the land the male shrine prostitutes
who remained from the days of his father Asa. [47] And there was no king in Edom;
a deputy served as king. [48] Jehoshaphat built ships of Tarshish to go to Ophir for
gold, but they never set sail, because they were wrecked at Ezion-geber. [49] At that
time Ahaziah son of Ahab said to Jehoshaphat, “Let my servants sail with your
servants,” but Jehoshaphat refused. [50] And Jehoshaphat rested with his fathers and
was buried with them in the city of his father David. And his son Jehoram reigned
in his place. [51] In the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat’s reign over Judah, Ahaziah
son of Ahab became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria two years. [52] And he
did evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the ways of his father and mother
and of Jeroboam son of Nebat, who had caused Israel to sin. [53] Ahaziah served and
worshiped Baal, provoking the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger, just as his father
had done.